

**Project SPEAK (Student Protection, Education, Awareness, and
Knowledge Against Cyberbullying): A School-Based Cyberbullying
Reporting, Monitoring, and Digital Citizenship Management System**

Author: Bersaline J. Rapal

Course: BS Nursing 4D

Date: August 20, 2026

I. Introduction

Cyberbullying has become a growing concern in today's digital era, where smartphones, social media, messaging applications, and online learning are integral to students' daily lives. While these technologies improve communication and access to information, they also provide new avenues for harmful online behavior. Unlike traditional bullying, cyberbullying can occur anytime and anywhere through digital platforms, making it difficult for victims to avoid. According to the Cyberbullying Research Center (2026), cyberbullying is the repeated use of digital technologies to intimidate, threaten, harass, humiliate, or embarrass another person. Similarly, UNICEF (2026) defines it as harmful behavior committed through social media, messaging applications, gaming platforms, and mobile devices that causes emotional, psychological, and social harm.

In the Philippines, cyberbullying has become a significant issue among school-aged children and adolescents. UNICEF (2026) reported that one in three young people worldwide has experienced cyberbullying, while 44% of Filipino children aged 13–17 have experienced it, placing the country among those with high rates of online abuse. Common forms include verbal abuse, spreading false information, impersonation, and sharing embarrassing content, which often result in anxiety, depression, low self-esteem, reduced academic motivation, and school absenteeism.

The Philippine educational system continues to face challenges in addressing cyberbullying effectively. The Department of Education (DepEd) recognizes bullying and cyberbullying as major threats to learners' safety and academic performance. The Revised Implementing Rules and Regulations of the Anti-Bullying Act of 2013 classify cyberbullying as bullying committed through electronic means, including texting, emailing, instant messaging, and social networking sites. DepEd further reports that the Philippines has one of the highest incidences of bullying, with cyberbullying becoming more prevalent due to the increasing use of online and blended learning.

Studies among Filipino adolescents further emphasize the harmful effects of cyberbullying. Shannen et al. (2021) found that cybervictimization is associated with lower empathy, poorer emotional health, and increased psychological distress. Likewise, Perez et al.

(2026) reported that senior high school students frequently experience cyberbullying through social networking and private messaging platforms, leading to fear, emotional trauma, and decreased academic motivation. These findings indicate that cyberbullying negatively affects students' emotional well-being, academic engagement, and interpersonal relationships.

Another major concern is the underreporting of cyberbullying incidents. UNICEF's *Disrupting Harm in the Philippines* report revealed that 55% of Filipino children do not know how to report harmful online content, while 44% do not know where to seek help when they or someone they know experiences online abuse. Fear of retaliation, embarrassment, and being ignored further discourages students from reporting incidents, preventing schools from providing timely interventions and appropriate support.

Given these challenges, there is a need for a more accessible, confidential, and technology-enabled approach to managing cyberbullying in educational institutions. This proposal presents Project SPEAK (Student Protection, Education, Awareness, and Knowledge Against Cyberbullying): A School-Based Cyberbullying Reporting, Monitoring, and Digital Citizenship Management System. The proposed system integrates anonymous incident reporting, evidence submission, case monitoring, guidance counseling support, and digital citizenship education into a centralized platform. In this proposal, the author seeks to develop and implement a system that promotes early intervention, encourages responsible online behavior, and strengthens collaboration among students, teachers, guidance counselors, and school administrators to create a safer, more inclusive, and supportive learning environment for Filipino students.

II. Problem Description

Despite the implementation of the Anti-Bullying Act of 2013 (Republic Act No. 10627) and school child protection policies, cyberbullying continues to challenge educational institutions in the Philippines. While schools have established procedures for addressing bullying incidents, many cases of cyberbullying remain unresolved because victims are often reluctant to report them. Fear of retaliation, embarrassment, peer judgment, and concerns about

confidentiality discourage students from seeking help, allowing incidents to continue unnoticed (UNICEF, 2022).

Another challenge is the absence of a centralized, technology-supported reporting process in many schools. A lot of institutions still rely on manual reporting procedures and paper-based documentation. Therefore, cyberbullying complaints are reported verbally or through paper-based documentation, making case management inefficient and inconsistent. Important digital evidence, such as screenshots, chat messages, or social media posts, may be lost or overlooked, while administrators and guidance counselors often face difficulties organizing records, tracking repeated offenders, and monitoring the progress of interventions. Without a systematic approach, schools cannot easily identify patterns or determine whether existing anti-bullying programs effectively reduce cyberbullying incidents.

Moreover, preventive education on responsible online behavior is often limited to occasional seminars or orientation programs. While these activities increase awareness, they may not provide continuous learning opportunities that encourage students to practice digital responsibility in their everyday online interactions. As internet usage and social media engagement continue to increase among Filipino adolescents, schools require more sustainable strategies that combine prevention, reporting, intervention, and monitoring into a unified approach (Perez et al., 2026).

Recent studies have shown that cyberbullying significantly affects students' academic performance and psychological well-being. Victims commonly experience anxiety, stress, fear, social withdrawal, decreased concentration, and reduced motivation to participate in school activities (Shannen et al., 2021). When these experiences remain unaddressed, they may contribute to declining academic performance, absenteeism, and long-term emotional distress. These consequences emphasize the need for schools to strengthen their support systems by providing students with accessible reporting mechanisms and timely interventions.

Given these challenges, there is a clear need for an integrated, school-based digital platform that not only simplifies the reporting of cyberbullying incidents but also supports case management, documentation, awareness campaigns, and digital citizenship education. A centralized system would enable school administrators and guidance counselors to respond more

efficiently while empowering students to report incidents safely and confidently. By addressing these existing gaps, educational institutions can better protect learners and promote a safer, more respectful, and more inclusive digital learning environment.

III. Proposal Solution

To address the increasing cases of cyberbullying among students, this study proposes Project SPEAK (Student Protection, Education, Awareness, and Knowledge Against Cyberbullying): A School-Based Cyberbullying Reporting, Monitoring, and Digital Citizenship Management System. Project SPEAK is a web-based and mobile-responsive platform designed to support schools in preventing, reporting, documenting, and managing cyberbullying incidents while promoting responsible digital citizenship among students. The proposed system is based on existing school incident reporting systems and digital citizenship initiatives recommended by organizations such as UNICEF. Rather than replacing existing disciplinary procedures, Project SPEAK strengthens current school child protection policies by providing a centralized, secure, and confidential platform that enables students, teachers, guidance counselors, and administrators to work together in addressing cyberbullying more efficiently.

One of the primary features of the system is its Secure Student Login, which allows students, teachers, guidance counselors, and school administrators to access the platform using their official school-issued credentials. This authentication process ensures that only authorized users can access the system while protecting students' personal information and maintaining confidentiality. To encourage students to seek help without fear of retaliation or embarrassment, Project SPEAK provides an Anonymous Incident Reporting feature. Through this function, students can confidentially submit reports regarding cyberbullying incidents without revealing their identity unless they voluntarily choose to do so. This feature is expected to increase reporting rates, especially among students who are hesitant to speak directly to school authorities.

To support investigations, the system also includes an Evidence Submission feature that enables students to upload screenshots, photographs, chat conversations, social media links, or other digital files as supporting evidence. Organizing evidence within the system helps guidance

counselors and school administrators review incidents more accurately and objectively. To assist school personnel in managing reported cases, Project SPEAK provides a Case Management Dashboard. Through this dashboard, authorized personnel can review submitted reports, classify incident types, assign cases to appropriate staff, update investigation progress, document counseling interventions, and close resolved cases. This organized workflow minimizes paperwork while ensuring that every reported incident is properly documented and monitored.

As an additional safety measure, the system incorporates an AI-assisted Detection of Abusive Language. This feature is intended to assist, not replace, human decision-making by identifying potentially offensive, threatening, or abusive words contained in submitted reports or uploaded conversations. Reports flagged by the system are forwarded to guidance counselors for proper review before any action is taken. This allows school personnel to prioritize urgent cases while maintaining fairness and accuracy in the investigation process. Project SPEAK also features an Incident Tracking and Analytics Dashboard, which automatically generates statistical summaries of reported cyberbullying cases. School administrators can monitor the number of reported incidents, identify the most common forms of cyberbullying, determine frequently affected year levels, analyze monthly or yearly trends, and evaluate the effectiveness of existing anti-bullying programs. These reports provide valuable evidence that supports data-driven planning and policy development.

Recognizing that prevention is equally important as intervention, the system includes a Digital Citizenship Learning Hub containing educational materials on responsible social media use, internet safety, privacy protection, respectful online communication, cyberbullying prevention, and ethical digital behavior. Students may access interactive learning modules, infographics, school announcements, and awareness campaigns that encourage empathy and responsible online participation. To ensure timely responses, Project SPEAK provides a Real-Time Notification System. Guidance counselors and designated school administrators immediately receive notifications whenever a new cyberbullying report is submitted. Likewise, students receive confidential status updates regarding the progress of their reports without compromising their identity or privacy.

The proposed system also emphasizes Secure and Confidential Data Management by implementing encrypted data storage, role-based user access, secure login authentication, and

compliance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (Republic Act No. 10173). These measures ensure that sensitive student information and cyberbullying records remain protected from unauthorized access while maintaining confidentiality throughout the investigation process. Finally, Project SPEAK allows school administrators to generate Downloadable Reports that summarize cyberbullying incidents, interventions, and case outcomes. These reports may be used for documentation, annual planning, policy evaluation, and the continuous improvement of school child protection programs.

IV. Conclusion

Cyberbullying has become a significant challenge affecting the safety, mental health, and academic performance of Filipino students. The widespread use of digital technologies has increased students' exposure to online harassment, making it essential for schools to adopt more effective approaches in preventing and responding to cyberbullying incidents. Although existing laws and school policies provide legal protection for learners, challenges such as underreporting, manual documentation, and limited awareness continue to hinder timely intervention.

Project SPEAK offers a practical and technology-enabled solution by integrating anonymous reporting, digital evidence submission, incident monitoring, case management, and digital citizenship education into one centralized platform. The proposed system not only strengthens the implementation of existing anti-bullying policies but also encourages students to report incidents without fear while enabling schools to respond efficiently and systematically. By promoting early intervention, improving communication among students and school authorities, and supporting responsible digital citizenship, Project SPEAK contributes to creating a safer, more inclusive, and more supportive educational environment. Ultimately, the implementation of this system can help reduce cyberbullying incidents, improve student well-being, strengthen school child protection mechanisms, and foster a culture of respect, empathy, and accountability both inside and outside the classroom.

V. References

Cyberbullying Research Center. (2026). *Cyberbullying data: Philippines*.
<https://cyberbullying.org/research/map/philippines>

Cyberbullying Research Center. (2026). *What is cyberbullying?*
<https://cyberbullying.org/what-is-cyberbullying>

Department of Education. (2013). *Implementing Rules and Regulations of Republic Act No. 10627 (Anti-Bullying Act of 2013)*.
<https://www.deped.gov.ph/deped-policies-and-child-protection-related-laws/>

Perez, J. J. B., Catalonia, R. K. C., Lapura, G. A. B., Canggag, A. L., & Maldepeña, K. M. V. (2026). *A case study on cyberbullying among senior high school students*. *International Journal of Research and Innovation in Social Science (IJRISS)*, 9(12), 3327–3338.
<https://doi.org/10.47772/IJRISS.2025.91200254>

Shannen, T., Kim, S.-J., & Lee, J. (2021). *Empathy, cyberbullying, and cybervictimization among Filipino adolescents*. *Child Health Nursing Research*, 27(1), 65–74.
<https://doi.org/10.4094/chnr.2021.27.1.65>

United Nations Children's Fund. (2026). *Cyberbullying: What is it and how to stop it*.
<https://www.unicef.org/stories/how-to-stop-cyberbullying>

United Nations Children's Fund. (2019). *Online bullying remains prevalent in the Philippines, other countries*.
<https://www.unicef.org/philippines/press-releases/online-bullying-remains-prevalent-philippines-other-countries>

United Nations Children's Fund. (2022). *Disrupting Harm in the Philippines*.
<https://www.unicef.org/philippines/reports/disrupting-harm-philippines>